

# FILM DOSSIER: THOR: STORMBREAKER

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Phase 2 · Film #2 (Saga Film #10)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                               |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 10 of 29 (Phase 2, Film #2)                                         |
| Phase                  | Phase 2                                                             |
| Real title             | <i>THOR: STORMBREAKER</i>                                           |
| Decoy / codename title | <i>"HORSE COUNTRY"</i>                                              |
| Release date           | Friday, July 26, 2013                                               |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                 |
| Director               | Kenneth Branagh                                                     |
| Rating / runtime       | PG-13 · 160 minutes                                                 |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>cosmic Norse saga / space opera</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                 |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>ESTHER SMILLEY</b> (Thor, film 2 of the franchise) |

| Character                                                                  | Actor                                                              | Age at release |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Thor / Dr. Donna Blake</b>                                              | <b>Esther Smalley</b>                                              | 30             |
| <b>Beta Ray Bill</b> ( <i>on-set performance capture and prosthetics</i> ) | Terry Crews ( <i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i> ) | 44             |
| <b>Malekith the Accursed</b>                                               | Christopher Eccleston                                              | 49             |
| <b>Algrim the Strong / Kurse</b>                                           | Adewale Akinnuoye-Agbaje                                           | 45             |
| <b>Odin</b>                                                                | Anthony Hopkins                                                    | 75             |
| <b>Frigga</b>                                                              | Rene Russo                                                         | 59             |
| <b>Jane Foster</b>                                                         | Natalie Portman                                                    | 32             |
| <b>Heimdall</b>                                                            | Idris Elba                                                         | 40             |
| <b>Sif</b>                                                                 | Jaimie Alexander                                                   | 29             |
| <b>Volstagg / Fandral / Hogun</b>                                          | Ray Stevenson / Zachary Levi / Tadanobu Asano                      | 49 / 32 / 39   |
| <b>Loki</b>                                                                | Tom Hiddleston                                                     | 32             |
| <b>Nick Fury</b>                                                           | Samuel L. Jackson                                                  | 64             |
| <b>Taneleer Tivan, the Collector</b> ( <i>post-credit</i> )                | Benicio del Toro                                                   | 46             |
| <b>Stan Lee</b> ( <i>cameo: a New Yorker shoveling snow in July</i> )      | Stan Lee                                                           | 90             |

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                           | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Primary comic(s) adapted</b> | <b>Walter Simonson's <i>Thor</i></b> , the definitive run: <b><i>Thor</i> #337–340</b> (1983–84), the coming of <b>Beta Ray Bill</b> , who <b>lifts Mjolnir</b> , and the forging of <b>Stormbreaker</b> ; <b><i>Thor</i> #344–349</b> (1984), <b>Malekith the Accursed</b> , the <b>Casket of Ancient Winters</b> , and <b>Algrim/Kurse</b> . |
| <b>Supporting comics</b>        | <i>Thor</i> #340–353 (Simonson, <b>Surtur</b> and the Twilight Sword, which is seeded here and pays off in Phase 3) · <b><i>The Thanos Quest</i> #1–2</b> (1990, Jim Starlin): Thanos takes the Gems from the <b>Elders of the Universe</b> , including <b>the Collector</b>                                                                   |
| <b>Nerf check</b>               | ✅ <b>Beta Ray Bill beats Thor</b> because of the <b>60-second rule</b> (she's separated from Mjolnir and turns back into Blake), exactly as in <i>Thor</i> #337. He then <b>proves himself worthy</b> . Neither of them is written weaker.                                                                                                     |

### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                         |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | 97%. Simonson's first year, adapted in order. |

#### Straight from the page:

- **S.H.I.E.L.D. detects an unknown starship** heading for Earth, and **Nick Fury** calls in Thor (*Thor* #337).
- **Beta Ray Bill**, champion of the **Korbinites**, a race whose home galaxy was destroyed by **Surtur's demons**, fights Thor. When Thor is **separated from Mjolnir for sixty seconds**, she **turns back into Blake**. Bill picks up the cane, strikes it, and **gets the power of Thor** (#337).
- **Odin summons "Thor" to Asgard and Bill arrives**. Odin orders a **trial by combat** on the fiery world of **Skartheim**. **Bill wins** (#338–339).
- Bill **refuses to keep a weapon he didn't earn**. Odin has the dwarves **forge Stormbreaker** for Bill, with the same enchantment as Mjolnir (#339–340).
- **Malekith the Accursed**, lord of the **Dark Elves**, steals **the Casket of Ancient Winters**. Opened on Earth, it would bring **endless winter** (#344–349).
- **Algrim the Strong** is betrayed by Malekith and **turned into Kurse**, a nearly unstoppable warrior sworn to revenge (#347–349).
- **Surtur is the power behind all of it** (#340 on). He's seeded here.

#### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Beta Ray Bill and Malekith (1983–84) in one film | Simonson's first year, told as one film |

| Thor's opponent in the 60-second fight is female | Thor has always been female in our universe. The fight is otherwise the same. |

| The Blake identity continues (on 616 it ended during Simonson's run) | It's held until the Phase 3 Thor film for story reasons |

#### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character                            | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                                                             | Shown in this film                                                                                           | Held back (why)                                                        | Match     |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Thor</b>                          | God-level strength; Mjolnir's full powers                                                                                                                                                                          | Breaks open a Dark Elf fortress; calls down a thunderstorm over the Arctic                                   | God Blast, Odinfence                                                   | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Beta Ray Bill</b>                 | Korbinite cyborg: <b>class-100 strength</b> , extreme durability, survives in space; <b>worthy of Mjolnir</b> ; wields <b>Stormbreaker</b> : flight, lightning, weather, a hammer that returns ( <i>Thor</i> #337) | All of it: he trades blows with Thor evenly, <b>lifts Mjolnir</b> , and wins the trial by combat on Skarheim | His warship <b>Skuttlebutt</b> (shown), and his full history (Phase 3) | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Malekith</b>                      | Dark Elf sorcerer: <b>teleportation, illusions, shape-shifting, ice and darkness magic</b> ( <i>Thor</i> #344)                                                                                                     | All of it; he impersonates Odin                                                                              | —                                                                      | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Kurse</b>                         | <b>Enormous strength and durability</b> (stood up to Thor and Bill together); armor; driven by revenge (#347)                                                                                                      | Takes on Thor and Beta Ray Bill at the same time                                                             | —                                                                      | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>The Casket of Ancient Winters</b> | Brings endless winter                                                                                                                                                                                              | <b>Manhattan freezes in July</b>                                                                             | —                                                                      | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Odin</b>                          | The Odinfence                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Presides over the trial; restores Algrim's mind                                                              | Full power (a saga-level moment)                                       | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>The Collector</b>                 | An <b>Elder of the Universe</b> : immortal, the galaxy's greatest collector                                                                                                                                        | The post-credit scene                                                                                        | —                                                                      | ✓<br>100% |

## 4. STORY

| Field                       | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Logline</b>              | A stranger with a horse's face and a hero's heart lifts Thor's hammer, and to save both their worlds from the Dark Elves' eternal winter, the god of thunder has to share the storm. |
| <b>Theme</b>                | <b>Worthiness isn't one person's property.</b> Anyone can be worthy, even a monster.                                                                                                 |
| <b>Villain / antagonist</b> | <b>Malekith the Accursed</b> (main); <b>Kurse</b> (tragic); <b>Surtur</b> (behind it all)                                                                                            |

## What the movie is about

### ACT ONE: THE STRANGER

- **Monday, May 20, 2013.** **Nick Fury** reaches Thor, now an Avenger, about an **unknown warship** crossing the orbit of Mars.
- Thor boards it. Its pilot, a towering, horse-faced cyborg named **Beta Ray Bill**, fights back. In the fight, Mjolnir is knocked away and **sixty seconds pass**. Thor turns back into **Dr. Blake** in the middle of the battle.
- Bill picks up the cane, **strikes it**, and **becomes a Thor**.

### ACT TWO: THE TRIAL

- Odin summons "Thor" home, and **Bill arrives**. Asgard is stunned.
- Bill explains that his people, the **Korbinites**, are the last survivors of a galaxy **burned by the demons of Surtur**. He needs Mjolnir to save them.
- Odin orders a **trial by combat** on **Skartheim**, a world of fire. It's **Thor against Bill**, and **Bill wins**.
- Bill **refuses to take the hammer from her**. Odin, moved, has the dwarves forge **Stormbreaker**. Bill has his own hammer now, and Thor has a brother-in-arms.

### ACT THREE: THE CASKET OF ANCIENT WINTERS

- **Malekith the Accursed** steals the **Casket of Ancient Winters** from Odin's vault and sacrifices his lieutenant **Algrim**, who is reborn as the monster **Kurse**.
- He takes the Casket to **Earth** and opens it over **Manhattan**, and **New York freezes in July**.
- **Thor and Beta Ray Bill** fight side by side through a frozen city, Mjolnir and Stormbreaker, two thunderstorms against the cold.
- **Kurse** is freed from Malekith's control, **turns on his master**, and takes Malekith with him into the void.
- Thor seals the Casket. The ice melts.
- Bill heads back to the Korbinites with Stormbreaker. At the Bifrost, Thor clasps his arm: "*Brother.*"
- Thor and **Jane** sit on a Manhattan rooftop in the thaw, their first real vacation.
- Odin, alone, looks into the fire: **Surtur is awake**.

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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Monday, May 20, 2013 → Saturday, June 29, 2013</b> . The post-credit scene is <b>undated</b> (somewhere in deep space).                                     |
| Where it's set          | <b>Mars orbit · Asgard · Skartheim · Svartalfheim</b> (the Dark Elf realm) · <b>New York City</b> (a frozen Manhattan, filmed with practical snow on location) |
| Relative to other films | <b>Six weeks after Iron Man 3</b> . Tony helps S.H.I.E.L.D. track Bill's ship by satellite, through Extremis, in one scene.                                    |

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## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **Beta Ray Bill**, **Stormbreaker**, and the **Korbinites**.
- **The Dark Elves** and **Malekith**.
- **Surtur**, the fire giant stirring in Muspelheim.
- **Worthiness** is now **a rule of the universe**, not just a family matter.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                         | How it appears                                                                                                                       | Payoff                                         |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The cosmos is crowded</b> | Bill's backstory: whole galaxies destroyed                                                                                           | Phase 2 cosmic films                           |
| <b>Surtur</b>                | Odin looking into the fire                                                                                                           | The Phase 3 Thor film (Simonson's Surtur saga) |
| <b>The Avengers on call</b>  | A frozen Manhattan: the Wasp flies rescue runs and Giant-Man clears the ice from the Brooklyn Bridge in a cameo                      | <i>Avengers 2</i>                              |
| <b>Loki</b>                  | Loki, still exiled, watches the Casket open and laughs. He tells Thor: <i>"You'll need more than a horse to stop what's coming."</i> | The next film Loki appears in                  |

### Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed                              | How it appears                                                                                                                                        | What it means                      |
|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>"The Infinity Gems"</b>        | Odin tells Thor about <b>the Elders of the Universe</b> and <b>the six Infinity Gems</b> . <b>This is the first time the name is said in the MCU.</b> | The Gems now have a name.          |
| <b>The Thanos Quest on screen</b> | The post-credit scene                                                                                                                                 | <b>Thanos takes his first Gem.</b> |

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## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | ✓ "SKUTTLEBUTT." Bill's warship crosses the dark between galaxies. On the bridge, Bill turns <b>Stormbreaker</b> over in his hands. The ship's AI speaks: <i>"Course set for the Burning Galaxy, Bill."</i> Bill: <i>"Then let's go home."</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Post-credit scene      | ✓ "THE COLLECTOR." The <b>Collector's</b> museum, a vast vault of alien specimens on a distant world. <b>Every display case is shattered.</b> The Collector, <b>Taneleer Tivan</b> , an Elder of the Universe, crawls across the floor to an <b>empty jewel setting</b> . Behind him, a <b>golden gauntlet</b> catches the light. <b>One of its six settings is no longer empty.</b> <b>THANOS</b> (off-screen): <i>"Keep your curiosities, Elder. I only came for the one."</i> <b>CUT TO BLACK. "THOR WILL RETURN."</b> |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: <b>"ROAD TRIP II."</b> Post-credit: <b>"GARAGE SALE."</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline